

THE INDIAN BRANDED RENTAL VILLA MARKET WAS ESTIMATED AT \$329.6 MILLION IN 2023 AND IS EXPECTED TO REACH \$1,377 MILLION BY 2028, ACCORDING TO AXON DEVELOPERS

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beat locations in over 15 states in India.

“Our guests travel in groups that include families, friends, corporate teams, board members, retreat participants, and expatriates. Their stays are often for a variety of occasions such as staycations, celebrations, team bonding sessions, discreet discussions, or simply to unwind and relax,” says Bazaz.

Lohono Stays, which launched just before the pandemic in 2019 with 20 villas, has expanded to over 300 villas in India, and to international destinations such as Phuket and Koh Samui in Thailand, Maldives, and Sri Lanka. It is also looking to expand into Europe with potential locations in Italy, Greece, and the South of France. “We have grown at 65% CAGR over five years. The company reported sales of about ₹700 crore in

FY24, up from ₹530 crore in FY23,” says Nibhrant Shah, Founder and CEO of Lohono Stays.

For Mumbai-based corporate lawyer Sharmila Shah, it is the space that villas provide that makes them most attractive. “In Mumbai we are so constrained for space that that is what we look forward to when on vacation. A villa rental provides me with the option of a home that I can only dream of,” she says with a smile.

Whether it is your need for space, privacy, flexible timings, customised meals (including Maggi), or a feel of a home away from home—complete with your furry friend by your side—renting a villa seems like an ideal vacation choice. **BT**

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